

PUBLIC SUBMISSION

As of: March 21, 2025
Received: March 15, 2025
Status: [REDACTED]
Tracking No. m8b-1ef7-x7h7
Comments Due: March 15, 2025
Submission Type: Web

Docket: NSF_FRDOC_0001
Recently Posted NSF Rules and Notices.

Comment On: NSF_FRDOC_0001-3479
Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

Document: NSF_FRDOC_0001-DRAFT-7389
Comment on FR Doc # 2025-02305

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General Comment

Public Comment on the AI Action Plan
To Whom It May Concern,

I appreciate the opportunity to provide input on the Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan. While fostering AI innovation is essential for maintaining U.S. leadership, this plan must also address critical concerns related to ethics, transparency, accountability, and public trust. Below are key recommendations that should be considered in shaping AI policy.

1. Ethical AI Development Must Be a Priority

The plan must include safeguards to prevent AI systems from perpetuating bias, invading privacy, or being misused. Without strong ethical guidelines, AI could disproportionately harm marginalized communities and erode civil liberties.

Bias Mitigation: AI models must be rigorously tested for algorithmic bias before deployment, particularly in areas like hiring, law enforcement, and healthcare.

Privacy Protections: AI-powered surveillance and facial recognition must be regulated to prevent overreach, ensuring that individuals' rights are not violated.

Accountability Measures: Developers must be held responsible for the negative consequences of AI-driven decisions, with clear guidelines on liability and redress.

A pro-innovation approach must not come at the cost of ethical responsibility. AI systems must align with democratic values and human rights protections.

2. AI Innovation Must Benefit All, Not Just Corporations

AI should not be dominated by a few large tech companies or military applications. The U.S. must ensure that AI innovation benefits small businesses, underserved communities, and public institutions.

Funding for Public AI Research: Government investment in non-profit AI projects can support healthcare, education, and environmental applications.

Reducing the Digital Divide: AI advancements should not exacerbate economic inequality—rural and low-income communities must have access to AI-driven tools.

Workforce Readiness: The plan must include reskilling programs to help American workers adapt to AI-driven changes in the job market. Without inclusive policies, AI will further entrench economic and social disparities. AI governance should ensure that innovation serves the public good, not just corporate profits.

3. Transparency and Accountability Are Essential

Many AI systems operate as "black boxes," making decisions without clear explanations. This is unacceptable, especially in criminal justice, hiring, finance, and government services.

Explainability Standards: AI used in high-stakes decision-making must provide clear, human-readable justifications for its actions.

Independent AI Audits: AI deployments should undergo third-party audits to ensure fairness, accuracy, and compliance with ethical

guidelines.

Public Access to AI Impact Assessments: Any AI system used by the government should be subject to mandatory transparency requirements, ensuring that the public can understand its impact.

AI cannot be allowed to make life-altering decisions without oversight. Transparency must be a non-negotiable requirement.

4. Public Education and AI Awareness Must Be Strengthened

Without widespread public knowledge about AI, misinformation and misunderstanding will grow.

AI Literacy Programs: Public education initiatives should teach how AI works, its risks, and how people can protect their rights.

Regulation of AI-Generated Misinformation: Deepfakes and AI-generated content must be closely monitored to prevent manipulation in elections and public discourse.

An informed public is essential for democratic decision-making on AI. Without proactive education efforts, AI policy will be dictated solely by corporate interests.

5. International AI Cooperation is Critical

AI is a global issue, and the U.S. must take a leadership role in establishing international AI safety standards.

Global AI Safety Agreements: AI risks—including autonomous weapons and cyber threats—must be addressed through international treaties.

AI Ethics in Trade Agreements: The U.S. should integrate AI governance and ethical standards into global trade discussions to prevent exploitative AI practices.

By working with allies, the U.S. can ensure AI is developed responsibly, preventing authoritarian regimes from exploiting AI for surveillance, repression, or disinformation.

Conclusion

The AI Action Plan must not focus solely on deregulation and reducing barriers to AI expansion. Instead, it must ensure:

- AI development aligns with ethical standards
- Innovation benefits the public, not just large corporations
- AI decision-making is transparent and accountable
- Public education initiatives strengthen AI literacy
- The U.S. leads in global AI safety and cooperation

I strongly urge policymakers to prioritize responsible AI development that safeguards civil liberties, economic fairness, and public trust. The future of AI must be shaped with careful oversight, not just a race for dominance.